郁金香狂热：泡沫与传说

Tulip Mania: The Bubble and the Legend



郁金香真的让整个荷兰破产了吗?

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In the winter of 1636–37, Dutch merchants and brokers met in taverns to trade contracts for tulip bulbs still in the ground, a speculative business they called windhandel, "trading in the wind". Prices of prized "broken" tulips, with streaked petals, soared.

In early February 1637, at a sale in Haarlem, the hub of the trade, no one would bid. Days later, at an auction in Alkmaar, one bulb still fetched 5,200 guilders, the Dutch currency of the day, more than a decade's wages for a skilled craftsman. But the frenzy was over. Prices collapsed, many buyers defaulted, and unsettled contracts piled up. Why the market turned so swiftly is still contested.

Two centuries later, Charles Mackay, a Scottish journalist, recounted the episode in a book on popular delusions, casting it as national hysteria. In his telling, rich and poor gambled, great merchants were reduced almost to begging, and Dutch commerce reeled. His vivid account made tulip mania shorthand for bubbles fuelled by reckless buying.

Yet the archives tell a smaller story. Mackay's story relied largely on satirical pamphlets of 1637 that preached against greed. Anne Goldgar, a historian at King's College London, scoured Dutch records and counted only a few hundred traders, mostly merchants and craftsmen. She found no bankruptcy caused by tulips and no measurable harm to the economy. Many buyers were later allowed to settle their contracts by paying a small fraction of the price, and few were ruined.

The boom was real but fleeting. What spread, and still circulates nearly four centuries on, was the moral: a sermon drawn from those pamphlets and retold by Mackay as history.

中文译文

1636至1637年冬天，荷兰商人和经纪人聚在小酒馆里，交易还埋在土中的郁金香球茎合约。他们把这门投机生意称为windhandel，即“风中交易”。名贵的“碎色”郁金香花瓣带有条纹，价格一路飙升。

1637年2月初，在交易中心哈勒姆的一场买卖中，竟无人愿意出价。几天后，阿尔克马尔的一次拍卖仍有一只球茎售得5200荷兰盾——那是当时荷兰的货币，金额超过熟练工匠十年的工资。但狂热已经结束：价格暴跌，许多买家违约，未结清的合约越积越多。市场为何如此迅速转向，至今仍有争议。

两个世纪后，苏格兰记者查尔斯·麦凯在一本讨论群体性错觉的书中重述此事，将它描绘成全国性的狂热。在他的笔下，穷人富人都参与赌博，大商人几乎沦为乞丐，荷兰商业遭到重创。他生动的叙述使“郁金香狂热”成为不计后果的买入所催生的投机泡沫的代名词。

然而，档案呈现的规模要小得多。麦凯主要依据1637年那些讽刺贪婪、劝人戒贪的小册子来讲故事。伦敦国王学院历史学家安妮·戈德加仔细搜遍荷兰档案，只找到数百名交易者，大多是商人和工匠。她未找到因郁金香而破产的案例，也未发现经济遭受可衡量损害的证据。许多买家后来获准只支付原价的一小部分便结清合约，倾家荡产者寥寥无几。

这场热潮真实存在，却很短暂。真正广为传播、近四个世纪后仍在流传的，是其中的道德教训：一篇源于那些小册子的训诫，被麦凯当作历史重新讲述。

“未找到破产或经济损害的证据”是档案研究的发现，不等于断言无人蒙受损失。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

broker n.
经纪人；交易中介
merchants and brokers

contract n.
合约；合同
contracts for tulip bulbs

speculative adj.
投机性的
a speculative business

soar v.
飙升；猛涨
soared

bid v.
出价；竞价
no one would bid

fetch v.
售得；拍出某价格
one bulb still fetched 5,200 guilders

frenzy n.
狂热
the frenzy was over

collapse v.
暴跌；崩落
Prices collapsed

default v.
违约；未履行付款义务
many buyers defaulted

contest v.
受到争议或质疑
is still contested

hysteria n.
群体性狂热
national hysteria

shorthand for 名词短语
……的代名词
shorthand for bubbles

reckless adj.
不计后果的；鲁莽的
reckless buying

archive n.
档案；档案资料
the archives tell a smaller story

satirical adj.
讽刺性的
satirical pamphlets

pamphlet n.
小册子
satirical pamphlets

scour v.
彻底搜寻；仔细查遍
scoured Dutch records

bankruptcy n.
破产
no bankruptcy caused by tulips

measurable adj.
可以衡量的
no measurable harm to the economy

settle v.
结清；了结合约
settle their contracts

fraction n.
一小部分；分数
a small fraction of the price

fleeting adj.
短暂的；转瞬即逝的
real but fleeting

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共36项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

merchant n.
商人

tavern n.
小酒馆

tulip n.
郁金香

streaked adj.
带条纹的

petal n.
花瓣

hub n.
中心；枢纽

auction n.
拍卖会

currency n.
货币

wage n.
工资；工钱

unsettled adj.
未结清的

pile up 动词短语
堆积；越积越多

swiftly adv.
迅速地

journalist n.
记者

recount v.
讲述；叙述

episode n.
事件；一段往事

popular delusion 名词短语
群体性错觉；大众妄想

gamble v.
赌博

commerce n.
商业；贸易

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共36项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

reel v.
遭受冲击；摇摇欲坠

vivid adj.
生动的；鲜明的

mania n.
狂热

bubble n.
投机泡沫

rely v.
依赖；依据

on prep.
表示依赖或依据的对象

preach v.
宣扬；说教

against prep.
反对；抵制

greed n.
贪婪

historian n.
历史学家

harm n.
损害

economy n.
经济

a art.
不定冠词，表示一份或一部分

of prep.
……的

boom n.
繁荣；热潮

circulate v.
流传；传播

moral n.
寓意；道德教训

sermon n.
训诫；说教

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Prices collapsed, many buyers _____, and unsettled contracts piled up.

02 Why the market turned so swiftly is still _____.

03 Mackay's story relied largely on _____ pamphlets of 1637 that preached against greed.

04 She found no bankruptcy caused by tulips and no _____ harm to the economy.

文章主线

- 热潮 1636至1637年，荷兰商人和经纪人交易尚在土里的郁金香球茎合约，稀有品种价格暴涨。
- 破裂 1637年2月买盘骤冷，仍有球茎卖5200盾、抵工匠十余年收入；随后价格崩落、违约堆积，原因仍有争议。
- 传说 两个世纪后，麦凯主要依据讽刺贪婪的小册子，把它写成全民投机、商人破产、经济重创的故事。
- 档案 戈德加查档只找到数百名交易者，未找到郁金香引发破产或经济遭受可衡量损害的证据。
- 辨别 许多买家只付原价一小部分便结清合约，鲜有人倾家荡产；热潮真实，广传的全国灾难故事却被放大。

参考答案　1 defaulted 2 contested 3 satirical 4 measurable